ABOUT THIS PIECE

Lesson plan: context clues in Charlotte's Web

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WHAT IT IS

A 10 to 15 minute 5th-grade vocabulary mini-lesson (ELA 5.4) on using context clues, built around Chapter 10 of Charlotte's Web.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

How the lesson ties a standard to a real text.

The work itself starts on the next page.

5TH GRADE · STUDENT TEACHING · ELA 5.4

Context Clues in Charlotte's Web

A Vocabulary Mini-Lesson Using Context to Infer Word Meaning

STANDARD	TIME	TEXT
ELA 5.4 — use context as a clue to the meaning of a word or phrase	10–15 minutes	Charlotte's Web, Ch. 10 “An Explosion”

Objective

Students will use context clues to determine the meaning of challenging vocabulary words from *Charlotte's Web*: **radiant**, **humbly**, and **summon**.

Materials

- Short passage from Charlotte's Web, Chapter 10
- Vocabulary worksheet (radiant / humbly / summon)
- Whiteboard and markers
- Visual aid — image of Charlotte's glowing web

Lesson Procedure

Pre-Reading (3 min)
Write “radiant,” “humbly,” and “summon” on the board. Ask: “What do you think these words mean? Have you heard or used them before?” Explain that the class will use the story's context to figure out the meanings together.

During Reading (7 min)
Read the passage aloud as a class, pausing at each vocabulary word. Guide discussion with context clues — e.g. “What is Charlotte feeling when she says the word ‘radiant’? How do we know?” Record student responses on the whiteboard.

Post-Reading (5 min)
Students complete the vocabulary worksheet individually: write the word, use context clues to infer the meaning, then write their own definition. Review answers together as a class.

Assessment

Collect the vocabulary worksheets to check for understanding, and observe student participation during the group discussion.

Differentiation

Pair struggling readers with peers for support, and provide visual aids or synonyms for the more difficult words.

Reflection

When the class analyzed “radiant,” students connected it to Charlotte's mood in the scene — a sign they were using context clues rather than memorizing a dictionary definition. The interactive discussion was the strongest part of the lesson; next time, adding a brief think-pair-share before the whole-class discussion would help quieter students build confidence before sharing out.